

Database

The default database for Django is **SQLite**, which is free open-source database software. It is a lightweight and serverless database, mainly used in small to medium-scale applications. It can be used at the production stage, but **MySQL** or **PostgreSQL** are more popular for production use. You can also use cloud database services. In this chapter, we use **PostgreSQL**

Web Server and Application Server

Two types of server functionalities are required for dynamic web applications – **web server** and **application server**. The key difference between those two servers is that the web server manages **static content** while the application server handles **dynamic content**.

Depending on the server software, the application server functionality can be part of web server software. For example, for **Apache**, which is popular web server software, the application server functionality is covered by an extended module. On the other hand, another popular web server, **Nginx**, focuses more on web server functionalities.

In this chapter, we use **Nginx** for a web server and **Gunicorn** for an application server.

For the application server functionality, Django supports two standard interfaces: **WSGI (Web Server Gateway Interface)** and **ASGI(Asynchronous Server Gateway Interface)**. Gunicorn is a WSGI server.

Summary

Here is the summary of software and service choices for our Django app deployment in this chapter.